

**Be More
at Bain**



Brainwars 2026

Case part 1 submission

Bainers - IIT(ISM),DHANBAD

Hit Pandya

Kharanshu Papolli

Sai Swapnil Mishra

Parth Patel

Project PULSE: Scaling Predictive Intelligence into India

Executive Summary

STRATEGIC LOGIC

INDIA ENTRY

Scale + Lowest CAC globally

HYBRID GTM

Telecom + D2C + Gym Partnerships

PULSEAI™ MOAT

Performance + Preventive Health

THREE QUESTIONS ANSWERED

GROWTH PATH

↑

International — India First

GTM MODEL

🏪

Hybrid: Telecom + D2C + Gym

AI POSITION

🧠

Performance + Preventive Health

FINANCIAL OUTCOMES · CORRECTED INDIA PRICING · (NA÷1.20)×0.95

\$94.1M

Yr 1 Revenue

500k units + 200k AI subs

\$14.7M

Yr 1 EBITDA

15.6% operating margin

490%

ROI on \$3M Entry

\$14.7M ÷ \$3M

75 Days

Payback Period

Base case, \$40 CAC

YEAR 1 INDIA P&L · BASE CASE

Hardware Revenue	\$76.4M
AI Sub Revenue	\$17.7M
Total Gross Revenue	\$94.1M
Total COGS + Cloud	-\$56.4M
Gross Profit (40%)	\$37.7M
CAC + Entry Costs	-\$23.0M
EBITDA	\$14.7M

SENSITIVITY (HYBRID MODEL — TELECOM \$150/\$5 + D2C \$40)

Scenario	EBITDA	ROI	Payback
Best (−10%CAC)	\$16.7M	557%	66d
Base Case	\$14.7M	490%	75d
Worst (+10%CAC)	\$12.7M	423%	86d

KEY INSIGHT: India: 22% CAGR, \$40 CAC (2.4× cheaper than NA), 500k Yr1 units — the ONLY market where revenue growth and AI training data compound simultaneously.

Strategic Context: Three Paths, One Clear Winner

Growth Path Selection

WHERE PULSEX STANDS TODAY · NORTH AMERICA					
600k Active Devices		40% AI Attach (240k subs)			
18% Annual Churn (43k/yr)		\$95 CAC vs India's \$40			
REVENUE MIX					
Hardware 65%		AI 25%		En 10%	
CHURN MATH: 18% × 240k subs = 43k lost/yr in NA. India's 200k new subs in Yr1 = net +157k globally. PulseX NEEDS this market.					
REGIONAL SCORECARD · ALL FIGURES CASE-DERIVED					
Metric	India ★	SE Asia	Europe	Mid.East	Lat.Am.
CAGR	22%	19%	14%	15%	13%
Yr1 Demand	500k	420k	350k	250k	220k
CAC	\$40	\$55†	\$80.6†	\$85	\$50†
Digi.Readiness	0.72	0.68	0.75	0.61	0.55
★ Case-stated † SEA=(\$3M+\$5M+\$2M)÷181,818=\$55 Europe=\$5M÷62k=\$80.6 LatAm=\$40+\$10=\$50					
KEY INSIGHT: 18% NA churn means PulseX loses 43k subscribers/yr — India adds 200k new ones. It is the only path that simultaneously grows revenue AND the AI training dataset.					
Executive Summary		Regional Prioritization		Competitor Analysis	

THREE GROWTH PATHS · STRATEGIC EVALUATION			
Growth Path	Status	Why Rejected / Selected	Key Risks
Domestic Deepening	REJECT	Saturated NA market. High CAC (\$95) static. 600k devices already active — no new AI training data. Incremental growth only.	Stagnation risk
Enterprise AI	LONG-TERM	High margin but 12–18 month B2B cycles. Low data volume — enterprise ≠ AI flywheel scale. Needs consumer moat first.	Year 3+ revisit
International — India ★	PRIORITIZE	22% CAGR + \$40 CAC = best ROI globally. 500k Yr1 units doubles PulseAI™ dataset. Digital readiness 0.72 primes subscriptions.	Regulatory, Churn

CAGR vs CAC EFFICIENCY MATRIX

High CAGR ↑

ME

EU

SEA

India

LatAm

← Higher CAC · Lower CAC →

GTM & Brand Adoption		Unit Economics		PulseAI™ Moat & Risks	
----------------------	--	----------------	--	-----------------------	--

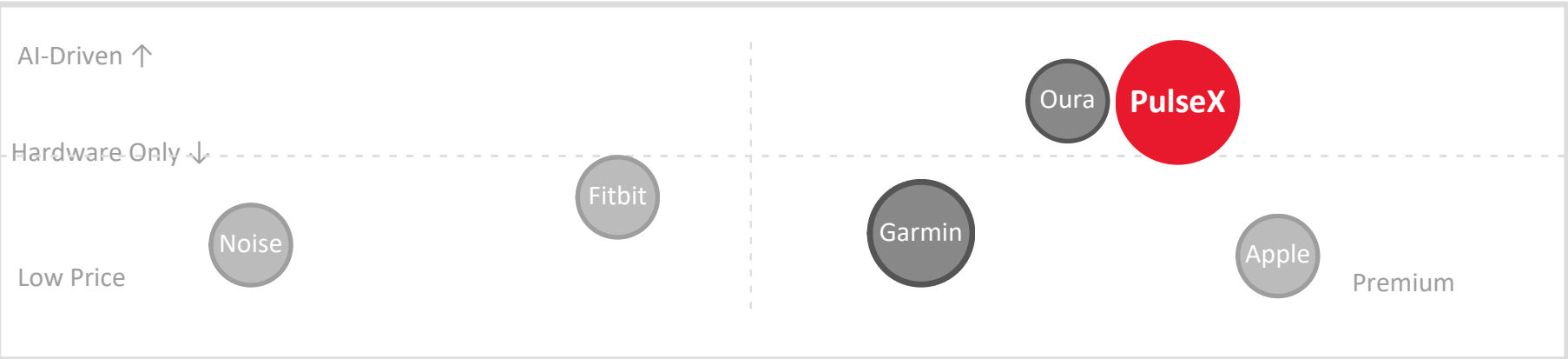
Competitor Analysis: The Gap PulseX is Built to Fill

India Competitive Landscape

India wearables market is dominated by budget brands (Noise/boAt) and single-purpose premium devices (Apple/Garmin/Oura). No player offers cross-device recovery intelligence.

Brand	Segment	India ASP	Product Focus	AI / Health	Competitive Gap	PulseX Advantage
Apple Watch	Premium	₹45,900+	Fitness + Lifestyle	Activity only; no injury/recovery AI	No cross-device data; no chest band correlation	PulseX Ring D2C targets same premium buyer - with real recovery prediction Apple cannot offer
Garmin	Sports/GPS	₹25,000+	GPS Accuracy, Endurance	Basic HRV; no AI predictions	Single device - no cross-sensor Readiness Score	Band+Watch combo gives PulseX strain x recovery data Garmin's architecture cannot replicate
Oura Ring	Sleep/Recovery	\$299 (limited India)	Sleep, HRV, Recovery	Recovery-focused but descriptive only	Recovery only - no strain or daily load data	Ring + Band = Oura + chest sensor in one ecosystem. Readiness Score is clinically richer
Noise / boAt	Budget	₹2,000–₹5,000	Basic step/HR tracking	No AI; no subscription model	No predictive health at any price point	PulseX does NOT compete here - targets ₹13k–₹17k premium + AI segment exclusively
Fitbit / Samsung	Mid-range	₹8,000–₹25,000	General wellness	Basic insights; limited ML	Generic recommendations; no 3-device correlation	PulseAI's injury forecasting + recovery scoring has no direct mid-market equivalent

INDIA MARKET POSITIONING MAP



MARKET OPPORTUNITY ANALYSIS

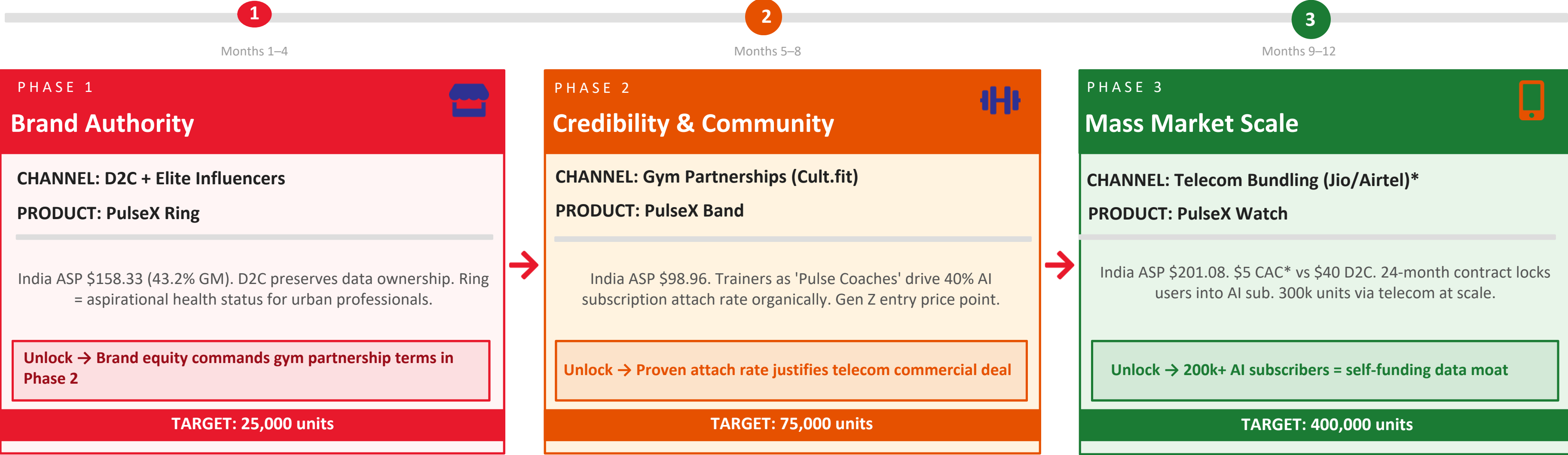
- Premium segment growing 147% YoY (2024)**
Apple Watch +141% in India 2024. PulseX enters a rising tide, not a declining one.
- No player has cross-device correlation data**
The Readiness Score (Strain × Load × Recovery) is structurally impossible for single-device brands.
- AI subscription = untapped model in India**
No Indian wearable brand has a recurring AI subscription. PulseX introduces an entirely new revenue category.

KEY INSIGHT: Apple & Oura are the real threats — neither has cross-device strain×recovery correlation. PulseX's Readiness Score is the gap no single-device competitor can bridge.

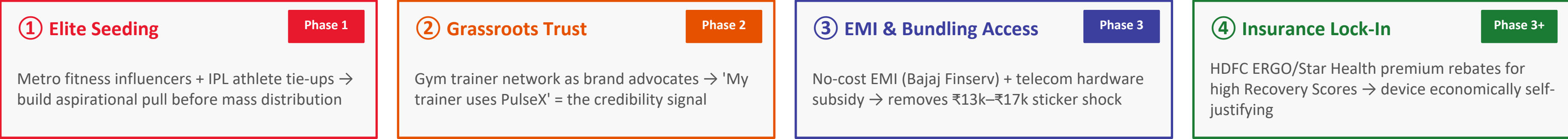
Go-To-Market & Brand Adoption: Phased Entry Mirrors How Premium Brands Win in India

GTM Strategy & India Brand Adoption Framework

HYBRID GTM MODEL · THREE PHASES, THREE PRODUCTS, CAUSALLY LINKED



INDIA BRAND ADOPTION LADDER · HOW NEW PREMIUM BRANDS WIN IN INDIA (VALIDATED PLAYBOOK)



Unit Economics & Year 1 P&L: India Pricing

Financial Analysis — Corrected: India ASP = (NA ÷ 1.20) × 0.95

PRICING METHODOLOGY: The case states India reflects a ~5% discount to the global average ASP — not to NA. Since NA commands +20% premium over global avg: **India ASP = (NA ÷ 1.20) × 0.95**
Watch: (\$254÷1.20)×0.95 = \$201.08 | Ring: (\$200÷1.20)×0.95 = \$158.33 | Band: (\$125÷1.20)×0.95 = \$98.96

INDIA UNIT ECONOMICS · ASPs				
Product	India ASP	Cost	GP/unit	GM%
Watch	\$201.08	\$140	\$61.08	30.4%
Ring	\$158.33	\$90	\$68.33	43.2%
Band	\$98.96	\$75	\$23.96	24.2%
Wtd Avg HW	\$152.79	\$102	\$51.13	33.5%
PulseAI Sub**	\$88.67	\$28	\$60.67	68.4%



AI SUBSCRIPTION FLYWHEEL

- ▶ 500k units × 40% attach = 200,000 AI subscribers
- ▶ 200k × \$60.67 GP = \$12.1M AI gross profit (68.4% GM)
- ▶ 68.4% AI GM vs 33.5% hardware GM — subs structurally superior
- ▶ 18% churn math: Yr2 net adds = 200k new – 36k churn = +164k globally

YEAR 1 INDIA P&L · BASE CASE · \$40 CAC ALL CHANNELS	
Hardware Revenue (500k × \$152.79 wtd avg)	\$76.4M
AI Sub Revenue (200k × \$88.67)**	\$17.7M
Total Gross Revenue	\$94.1M
Hardware COGS (500k × \$101.67 wtd avg)	−\$50.8M
AI Cloud Cost (200k × \$28)	−\$5.6M
Total Gross Profit (40.0% GM)	\$37.7M
CAC / Marketing (500k × \$40)	−\$20.0M
Fixed Entry Investment	−\$3.0M
EBITDA (Year 1)	\$14.7M
Operating Margin	15.6%
Payback on \$3M setup (base case)	~75 days

SENSITIVITY · HYBRID MODEL (TEAM ASSUMPTION: TELECOM \$150 ASP + \$5 CAC)					
Scenario	D2C CAC	Tel.CAC	EBITDA	ROI	Payback
Best (−10%)	\$36	\$4.50	\$16.7M	557%	66d
Base Case	\$40	\$5.00	\$14.7M	490%	75d
Worst (+10%)	\$44	\$5.50	\$12.7M	423%	86d

KEY INSIGHT: At corrected margins, 490% ROI on \$3M remains exceptional. AI/hardware GM gap (68.4% vs 33.5%) means every 1pp gain in attach rate is worth more than any CAC reduction.

PulseAI™ Moat, Risk Register & Final Recommendation

Strategic Positioning, Execution Plan & Risk Mitigation

PULSEAI™ 3-DEVICE DATA MOAT	
1	PulseX Band Strain (Exertion) · India \$98.96 · 24.2% GM · Gym Ch.
2	PulseX Watch Load (Daily Activity) · India \$201.08 · 30.4% GM · Telecom.
3	PulseX Ring Recovery (Sleep+HRV) · India \$158.33 · 43.2% GM · D2C.
THE MOAT: Strain (Band) + Load (Watch) + Recovery (Ring) = Readiness Score. Oura has recovery. Garmin has load. Apple has brand. Nobody has all three correlated.	

POSITIONING · CASE Q3 ANSWER

✓ Performance Differentiator	Readiness Score — Strain×Recovery×Load. Unique to 3-device ecosystem.
✓ Preventive Health Tool	India: 101M diabetics, 315M hypertensive. Metabolic tracking = sticky sub.
— Enterprise Analytics	Year 3+ — needs consumer moat first.
— Insurance Risk-Scoring	Phase 3+ via HDFC ERGO/Star Health B2B2C flywheel.

Risk	Prob	Impact	Mitigation
Import Duty Spike	Med	High	PLI Scheme → local assembly, duty ~0%
CDSCO Regulatory Delay	Med	Med	\$0.6M allocated. Begin Class B filing pre-entry (3–6 months)
Telecom Deal Failure	Low	High	Phase 1–2 D2C builds proof-of-demand as commercial leverage
Local Competition (Noise)	High	Med	PulseX targets ₹13k+ premium & AI — not the ₹2k segment
DPDP Act Compliance	Low	High	\$1.1M IT allocation → AWS Mumbai local cloud from Day 1

OUR RECOMMENDATION



PulseX enters India Yr1 via Hybrid GTM: D2C Ring (brand equity) → Gym Band (AI attach proof) → Telecom Watch (scale at \$5 CAC*). Positioned as **Performance + Preventive Health Platform**, PulseAI™ compounds with India's 500k Yr1 dataset to build a Readiness Score no single-device competitor can replicate. **\$3M in → \$14.7M EBITDA → 490% ROI.**

**Be More
at Bain**

THANK YOU!